Thinking about quantum mechanics in QBist terms has led to interesting developments in the mathematics of probability, and offers insight into quantum information theory. Most physicists, however, will still want to know: What is reality supposed to be in this view? (Abraham Pais recalled that Einstein once asked him whether he "really believed that the moon exists only when I look at it.")

The answer is not clear. Imagine that we send an electron through a Stern-Gerlach magnet, but we choose not to look at whether it's deflected up or down. For an Everettian, it is nevertheless the case that decoherence and branching has occurred, and there is a fact of the matter about which branch any particular copy of ourselves is on. The QBist says something very different: there is no such thing as whether the spin was deflected up or down. All we have is our degrees of belief about what we will see when we eventually decide to look. There is no spoon, as Neo learned in *The Matrix*. Fretting about the "reality" of what's going on before we look, in this view, is a mistake that leads to all sorts of confusion.

QBists, for the most part, don't talk about what the world really is. Or at least, as an ongoing research program, QBists have chosen not to dwell too much on the questions concerning the nature of reality about which the rest of us care so much. The fundamental ingredients of the theory are a set of *agents*, who have *beliefs*, and accumulate *experiences*. Quantum mechanics, in this view, is a way for agents to organize their beliefs and update them in the light of new experiences. The idea of an agent is absolutely central; this is in stark contrast to the other formulations of quantum theory that we've been discussing, according to which observers are just physical systems like anything else.

Sometimes QBists will talk about reality as something that comes into existence as we make observations. Mermin has written, "There is indeed a common external world in addition to the many distinct individual personal external worlds. But that common world must be understood at the foundational level to be a mutual construction that all of us have put together from our distinct private experiences, using our most powerful human invention: language." The idea is not that there is no reality, but that reality is more than can be captured by any seemingly objective third-person perspective. Fuchs has dubbed this view *Participatory Realism*: reality is the emerging totality of what different observers experience.